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MARCH TO 250

The battle of Lexington vs. Concord

Historical umbrage flares over claim first shots of Revolution were fired at Old North Bridge



JOANNE RATHE/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

A Lexington Minute Men member stood on the town green last year near the statue memorializing the battle of April 19, 1775.

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

LEXINGTON — On April 19, 1775, the Revolutionary War began. On April 20, 1775, Concord and Lexington began fighting over where exactly that war began.

Now, with the 250th anniversary approaching, shots are flying again in this long-running dispute over who deserves credit as the birthplace of the war that ultimately led to the establishment of the United States of America.

It's a long saga, and includes a contentious stretch in the 19th century centered around a Concord monument and a poem by Ralph Waldo Emerson, which we'll get into in a moment. But it restarted in earnest a few weeks ago, when Concord250, the organization overseeing the anniversary events for the

“The first shots were fired in Lexington. For historians, this matter is not in dispute. I don't know what Concord is up to other than to try to claim they're the center of the universe.”

ROBERT ALLISON, *history professor at Suffolk University*

town, sent out a release inviting the media to Concord to commemorate “when the first shots of the American Revolution were fired at Concord's Old North Bridge.”

That's simply not true, said Robert Allison, a history professor at Suffolk University. “The first shots were fired in Lexington. For historians, this matter is not in dispute,” said Allison, who is also the president of the Colonial Society of Massachusetts. “I don't know what Concord is up to other than to try to claim they're the center of the universe.”

That's the kind of statement that will get you a free beer in Lexington, where the rivalry between the two towns runs deep — they play each other in football on Thanksgiving — and will continue this April 19 with huge competing gala celebrations, Concord250

LEXINGTON, Page A17

Study abroad: Right looks to Hungary on higher ed

Orbán's purge of schools inspires US conservatives

By Hilary Burns and Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

When President Trump and his allies think of the idealized version of higher education, they don't look to the Ivy League or the revered universities of the United Kingdom. They look to Hungary, a middle-tier economy without a single college or university ranked among the world's top 400.

Over the past 15 years, Hungary's right-wing prime minister, Viktor Orbán, has installed political allies in leadership roles, slashed funding for independent scientific research, and cut support for the humanities in what he has described as a campaign to save universities from financial ruin and, crucially, root out the pernicious influence of left-wing radicals and globalists.

“I think his way has to be the model for us,” Vice President JD Vance said of Orbán's approach last year.

Orbán, a populist strongman, has attempted to wrest control of his country's universities from academics and administrators he views as hostile to

HUNGARY, Page A12

Friday night is firing time in Trump world

Biggest bloodletting often at week's end

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — For all the unpredictability of President Trump's second administration, he has turned one expression of chaos into a ritual so consistent that Washington can set its collective watch to it every week.

Every Friday of his presidency so far — once the sun sinks low in the sky and quitting time rolls around in the nation's capital — Trump gets busy firing people.

Four-star generals, senior agency officials, rank-and-file federal employees — all have found themselves handed pink slips by the president or his deputies near the close of business in Washington on Friday, or sometimes well past it.

In his first term, Trump made liberal use of the “Friday night news dump,” the bipartisan Washington tradition of quietly disclosing bad or unflattering news at the end of the week in hopes of minimizing the damage. Of course, the heart of the workweek sees a now-common avalanche of

FRIDAYS, Page A14

MGB streamlining roils medical staff

Upheaval adds to work stress as leaders push to improve patient care, efficiencies

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

On Feb. 10, the same day Mass General Brigham announced that it would lay off hundreds of employees, two veteran physician-scientists who ran a clinical trial center at Massachusetts General Hospital learned they would be dismissed that week.

Dr. David Nathan and Dr. Mason Freeman, both of whom are endocri-

nologists, said they were floored. Each had worked at the hospital for more than 40 years. MGB, their hospital's corporate parent, had said the layoffs would involve administrators and managers, and spare front-line medical workers. But as Nathan and Freeman frantically explained to MGB in an email, they oversaw the care of hundreds of sick patients annually who receive experimental

treatments at the 18-bed center. The patients have everything from ALS to a rare childhood neurological disorder.

Before the week was out, Nathan and Freeman said, MGB told them it had made a mistake and they wouldn't be terminated after all. They would remain at the center as codirectors while the health system merged it with a similar unit at Brigham and Women's Hospital. The two physician-scientists agreed to help the leader of the new combined

MGB, Page A17

New England has plenty of arts offerings this spring. See a special edition of the **Globe Magazine**.

Pete Rose isn't the only stat-worthy candidate denied en-



try to the Hall of Fame for acts not in the box score, writes Dan Shaughnessy. **C1.**

Daylight saving time starts early Sunday. Set your clocks ahead an hour.

A course in brisk management

Sunday: Sun, wind. High: 42-47. Low: 32-37.

Monday: Sun, warmer. High: 49-54. Low: 33-38.

High tide: 8:07 a.m. 9:00 p.m.

Sunrise: 7:06 Sunset: 6:44

Complete report, **B10.** Deaths, **A18-24.**

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